SNEHA®
SOCIETY FOR NUTRITION, EDUCATION AND HEALTH ACTION

Education Assistance Policy

Correspondence: Behind Bldg. No. 11, BMC Colony, Shastri Nagar, Santacruz (W), Mumbai 400054 • Tel: 26614488 / 26606295
Head Office : 310, 3rd floor, Urban Health Centre, 60 Feet Road, Dharavi, Mumbai 400017 • Tel: 24042627 • Fax: 24086011
Chembur: 25226123 / 25220268 • **Matunga:** 65332628 • **Thane:** 25336003 / 04
www.snehamumbai.org • Crisis Centre: 24040045

I. OBJECTIVE

To provide assistance to our Community Organisers and equivalent, by way of reimbursing the tuition fees for higher studies. This could be high school certifications, graduate / post graduate programs that are job relevant.

II. ELIGIBILITY

All full time Community Organisers and equivalent, who have completed at least one year of service with SNEHA and received a performance rating of "3" or higher in their last performance review.

Employee should have cleared the last examination taken (Secondary School/ Higher Secondary School /Degree/Diploma or equivalent) for before applying for the assistance.

III. APPLICATION APPROVING AUTHORITY

Applications that fall within the framework of this policy and follow the below mentioned procedure can be approved by the below mentioned approving authorities in consultation with HR and Finance.

Area	Approving Authority
All Programs	Respective Program Directors
Domains	Respective Domain Heads
Domains reporting directly to CEO	CEO

IV. POLICY

i. Employee can enrol in high school/ graduate / post graduate degree program or take courses only at a fully accredited school, college or university.

ii. The course/program should be a part time (class attendance during non-working hours of SNEHA / non-working Saturday and Sunday) OR distance learning program.

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iii. The funds provided to eligible employee under this benefit are available only for the reimbursement of tuition costs. Institutional fees, textbooks, supplies and other costs cannot be clubbed under this benefit.

iv. An eligible employee would be reimbursed 50% of the entire course/program fee payable by them for acquiring a high school / graduate / post graduate degree OR Rs. 10,000/- whichever is lower as Education Assistance.

v. The amount will be paid in tranches. The first installment of the education assistance would be paid to the eligible employee when he/she joins a particular course/program as admission fee.

vi. The 2nd installment would be paid to the eligible employee upon successful completion of the first Semester or course/program completion whichever is applicable. 3rd installment will be paid accordingly if applicable. Therefore, the fee will be paid only after clearing the previous semester exams.

vii. It is mandatory to produce documents indicating that employee has successfully passed the previous semester to avail benefit for the next semester under this policy.

viii. Employee cannot claim the complete eligibility amount for any one semester only. The amount of reimbursement will be equally divided semester wise in cases where the course/program is semester based.

ix. Employee who has already enrolled for a course/program prior to this policy coming into effect can claim reimbursement only for future semesters for that particular course/program.

x. An employee can avail this benefit only twice in their career with SNEHA

xi. A minimum gap of 3 years from receiving the last reimbursement (for one complete course/program) is required between availing this benefit a second time.

xii. The payment/Reimbursement will be made to the employee and not to the Institution.

xiii. Benefit of this policy can be claimed in **3 scenarios**:

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A. **Prior to enrolling for the course/program** – Employee can approach the approving authority before an employee enrolls for the course/program.

B. **Immediately after enrolling for the course/program** - Employee can approach the approving authority after the employee has enrolled in a course/program and made the first payment to the institute.

C. **For an ongoing course/program** - Employee can approach the approving authority to claim benefit for an ongoing course/program they are pursuing for which benefit has not been claimed under this policy.

xiv. If the performance of an employee at work falls below acceptable levels, the approving authority may recommend HR to discontinue payment of further fees.

xv. HR will keep a record of all claims, payments and reimbursements being made under this policy.

xvi. The employee has to submit final results once course/program is completed.

V. APPROVAL PROCESS

a. The employee submits the following documents to the approving authority:

- Institute Application Form (filled at the time of applying for the course/program)
- Prospectus and Fee structure
- Course/program Start and End Date details
- How the applicant expects to use the degree/certification to further his/her work at SNEHA.
- Passing certificate/results of (Secondary School/ Higher Secondary /Degree/Diploma or equivalent)
- Results of previous semester/s (applicable only if benefit is being availed under Scenario B & C as given above)
- First Payment Receipt made to the Institute(applicable only if benefit is being availed under Scenario B)
- Notice of payment of fee issued by the Institution(applicable only if benefit is being availed under Scenario B & C)
- Education Assistance Form (applicable only if benefit is being availed under Scenario A)
- Education Reimbursement Form (applicable only if benefit is being availed under Scenario B & C)

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b. The Request for education assistance must be submitted 30 days prior to enrolling for the course/program in case the employee wants the education assistance at the time of enrollment in the course/program.

c. The course/degree/certification being sought (including the institution) must be approved by the respective approving authority.

d. Whether or not a particular course/degree/certification is professional or directly related to the job or will be helpful to the employee concerned in performance of his work, will be decided by the organization at its sole discretion and the same shall be final. The approving authority has to ensure that pursuance of any course/degree/certification by an employee should not in any way hamper the smooth flow of work in the department.

e. The approving authority sends a recommendation to HR for payment/reimbursement of course/program fee as applicable.

f. HR checks the eligibility of the employee as per guidelines of the policy, verifies the documents and checks the eligibility amount payable under the policy.

g. On verification, HR forwards the application to Finance with recommendation for overall limit sanction check along with all the original payment receipts (wherever applicable).

h. Finance does its due diligence and makes the payment to the Employee. Finance informs HR about the payment.

i. HR sends an email to Employee confirming payment.

j. Any deviation or special consideration will require recommendation from the Program Director / Domain Head and approval from the CEO.

This Policy will come in effect from 1st December 2017. Employees cannot claim benefit under this policy for payments made to the Institute prior to 1st December 2017.

Vanessa D'souza
Chief Executive Officer

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Education Assistance Application Form
(To be filled prior to enrollment or immediately after enrollment in a course)

Full Name:	
Employee Number:	
Domain/Program:	
Date of Joining SNEHA:	

Certification / Course Name:	
Start Date:	
End Date:	
Name & Location of Institution:	
Tuition Fee Amount (Annual):	

How will this course/program benefit me in my current job?

I have reviewed the Education Assistance Policy and understand the terms and conditions of the policy. I have attached all the documents required as per the policy with the Education Assistance Application Form.

Signature of Employee

Program Director/Domain Head/CEO

Signature of HR

Signature of Finance

Application for Education Assistance Reimbursement
(To be filled for on-going course)

Name:	
Employee Number:	
Domain/Program:	
Date of Joining:	
Certification / Course Name:	
Start Date:	
End Date:	
Name & Location of Institution:	
Amount of fee reimbursement requested:	
Please mention the Semester /Year for which the reimbursement is being requested for:	
Grade in Previous completed Semester/Year	

I have reviewed the Education Assistance Policy and understand the terms and conditions of the policy. I have attached all the documents required as per the policy with this request for Education Assistance Reimbursement:

Signature of Employee

Program Director/Domain Head/CEO

FOR OFFICE USE ONLY

Signature of HR

Signature of Finance